YEH JUN LEE

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Marketing — Pamplin College of Business, Virginia Tech Aug 2021 – 2026
Dissertation defended August 2026. Dissertation: *"The Sensory Connotation of Meaning and the Cues That Fit a Brand"*
Advisor: Prof. Frank May

M.S., Marketing — Korea University Business School Mar 2018 – Mar 2020
GPA 4.50 / 4.50 · Academic Excellence Award (highest academic performance in class)
Thesis: *"Safety Paradox of Self-Driving Cars"* (Advisor: Prof. Jongwon Park)

B.B.A. — Korea University Business School Mar 2009 – Feb 2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Grounded cognition and sensory marketing; cross-modal correspondence and brand meaning; large language models as validated measurement instruments; promotions and product choice; spatial cognition; consumer responses to AI.

Methods: experimental design and preregistration; psychometric validation and instrument development; LLM-based measurement; text embeddings and computational text analysis; computer vision features; mixed-effects modeling; field and market-level studies.

PUBLICATION

Lee, Y. J., & Park, J. (2022). The safety paradox of self-driving cars. *Asia Marketing Journal*, 23(4), 1.

JOB MARKET PAPER

"From Brand Meaning to Sensory Design: A Shared Map for Choosing Brand Cues"
Sole-authored working paper · targeted to the Journal of Marketing

Osgood showed that words carry an affective layer of meaning. This paper asks whether they also carry a sensory one. Drawing on embodied cognition and crossmodal correspondence, it proposes that abstract meanings such as power, intimacy, or renewal occupy reproducible positions in a sensory space, and that a color, a typeface, or a scent can be placed in the same space. The fit between what a brand means and how it looks or smells then becomes something a manager can compare before launch, not something discovered after it. An AI-based instrument recovers these positions from language. Across eight studies and a preregistered replication, they agree with human judgments, explain how similar distant concepts feel beyond semantics and affect, and predict which cues people see as fitting a brand.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

"SimSang: Mapping the Geometry of Thought," *Association for Consumer Research*, Chicago, September 2026.

"SimSang: Mapping the Geometry of Thought," *Society for Consumer Psychology*, San Diego, March 2026.

"The Geometry of Thought," *Association for Consumer Research*, Washington, D.C., October 2025 (Art Festival; interactive system demonstration).

"Spatial Sensitivity: Unveiling Its Effects on Consumer Choice and Perception," *Marketing Science (ISMS)*, Sydney, June 2024.

"Exploring the Impact of AI on Creative Processes: The Role of Baseline Creativity and Intrinsic Motivation," *Marketing Science (ISMS)*, Miami, June 2023 (with Dipankar Chakravarti).

"Safety Paradox of Self-Driving Vehicles," *American Marketing Association Summer Conference*, August 2020.

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

Multisensory congruence in hotels. Working paper with Prof. Eojina Kim and Heesun Park. Places hotel scents and lobby visuals on shared sensory axes and asks whether a scent that matches the space raises its appeal or one that counterbalances it works better.

Spatial sensitivity. People judge spatial change against a range, as they do prices; bounding a scene shrinks the range, so the same movement feels farther and a future event feels further off (five studies).

Promotions and usage breadth. Discounts may favor products that keep more uses open, because promotions prompt purchases before a use is settled; in Amazon market data, the sale bump is larger for multi-use products.

Sensory coloring of marketing slogans. How the felt sensory coloring of a slogan shapes brand fit and attitudes, and how it can guide generative-AI slogan writing and selection. Pilot testing under way.

Natural-language product search. Whether reading the sensory coloring of shoppers' queries with Jev, a fast AI judgment model, makes natural-language search faster and better than keyword or semantic search.

RESEARCH PLATFORMS

Färbung — natural-language fragrance search engine 2026 – present
Applies the sensory-connotation measure from my job market paper to search: a shopper's plain-language request ("a rainy Sunday morning") is placed on the same seven-axis sensory map as more than 26,000 fragrance listings, which are ranked by fit within seconds. Bilingual English/Korean. farbung.web.app

SimSang Typeface Finder 2026 – present
1,569 typefaces ranked against 356 meanings on a shape × weight × feel representation. simsang-type.web.app

SimSang — perceptual dictionary and scent translator 2025 – present
Public deployment of the dissertation instrument, mapping abstract concepts to sensory profiles and fragrance space. simsang-202503.onrender.com

IVDV Explorer 2024 – present
Literature platform organizing 64,125 variables from 28,570 marketing and psychology papers by construct (IVs, DVs, moderators, mediators). ivdv-cddf3.web.app

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record, Virginia Tech
- Consumer Behavior (undergraduate) — Spring 2026
- Marketing Research (undergraduate) — Spring 2026
- International Marketing (undergraduate) — Spring 2023

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Korea University Feb 2019 – Mar 2020

HONORS AND AWARDS

ACR Sheth Foundation Scholarship, Association for Consumer Research	2026
Best Track Award in Consumer Behavior, AMA Summer Conference	2020
Academic Excellence Award, Korea University Business School	2019
Research Assistant Scholarship, Korea University Business School	2019 – 2020
Academic Excellence Scholarship, Korea University Business School	2018

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Franklin Templeton Investments — Marketing Associate Nov 2015 – Dec 2016
Launched two flagship retail funds; developed promotional events and materials; contributed to the Korea-market brand evolution project.

SKILLS

Methods & analysis: R (mixed models), Python (pandas, statsmodels, scikit-learn), experimental design, text embeddings, computer vision features.
Engineering: JavaScript/HTML/CSS, Firebase, SurveyJS, Git; LLM APIs (Anthropic, Google, OpenAI).
Research operations: Qualtrics, CloudResearch, Prolific, SONA.
Languages: Korean (native), English (fluent), Chinese (HSK 5).